



Turn cooing into a game

Hold or rest your baby in her bouncy chair in front of you so you are looking straight into each other's eyes. Make a clear cooing sound, exaggerating your facial expression as you do. If she responds with a similar sound, repeat it back to her. Make more sounds back and forth for as long as she remains interested. Playing with clear vocal sounds like this helps her to distinguish speech from other noises.

Bond more deeply

So much has happened in your baby's short life that her birth may seem like it was ages ago. Look at your prenatal scans and photos of her as a newborn to revisit the feelings of awe she inspired. Or you may want to recall the moment when you saw she was safe, or a happy memory soon after she was born. In addition to being a positive experience (and helping you work through any mixed feelings you may have about the birth itself), this process releases the hormone oxytocin—known to stimulate feelings of attachment—in your brain to actively deepen your bond with her.

